



RIVERS

Rivers are very powerful, so powerful that the force of the moving water is able to change the shape of the land. As they flow through mountains and over plains, rivers carry away huge amounts of rock, sand, and mud. They then dump it somewhere else, usually on riverbanks or in the sea, to make new land.



Over the top

When a river tumbles over the edge of a steep cliff or over a hard, rocky ledge, it is called a waterfall. This one is in Brazil, South America.

As the river flows quickly down steep slopes, it wears away the rock to make a V-shaped valley.

Sand, mud, and gravel is left by the water as sediment.

A river usually begins in mountains or hills. Its water comes from rain or melted snow.

Where the rock is hard, the river makes rapids or waterfalls.

Glacier

Oxbow lake

